Mingjie Cao

Ph.D. Student in Accounting, Desautels Faculty of Management, McGill University

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EDUCATION

McGill University, Desautels Faculty of Management 2024–present
Ph.D. in Management (Accounting). Montreal, QC.

University of Toronto (St. George) 2022–2023
M.A. in Economics. Toronto, ON.

Université de Montréal 2018–2022
Honours B.Sc. in Economics. Montreal, QC.

RESEARCH

Research interests: Political economy and capital markets.

Methods: Textual analysis, machine learning, causal inference.

Working papers

"Do Analysts Understand Geopolitics? Evidence from Foreign Demand Shocks." (sole-authored, second-year summer paper)
Presented at McGill University, Desautels Faculty of Management, 2026.

"Measuring Firm-Level Geopolitical Exposure." (sole-authored, first-year summer paper)
Presented at the 12th Annual International Corporate Governance Society (ICGS) Conference, 2026 (nominated for the Best Paper Award); McGill University, Desautels Faculty of Management, 2025.

Work in progress

"Who Sets the Materiality Line? Regulatory Discretion and the Labeling of Accounting Errors." (sole-authored)

RESEARCH ASSISTANTSHIP

University of Toronto, Rotman School of Management Mar 2023–Sep 2023
Graduate Research Assistant, supervised by Professor Ole-Kristian Hope.
Compiled and verified corporate diversity disclosure data for hundreds of Canadian firms; proofread and refined the manuscript.
Project: Bourveau, T., X. Gao, and O.-K. Hope, "The Impact of Disclosure on Diversity: Evidence from the *Canada Business Corporations Act*," *Contemporary Accounting Research* (2026).

HONOURS, AWARDS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

Best Paper Award Nominee, 12th Annual ICGS Conference.	2026
Bertram Scholarship, Canadian Foundation for Governance Research ($20,000).	2026
Friends of McGill Fellowship, McGill University ($10,000).	2026
Graduate Excellence Award, McGill University ($9,100).	2024–2026
Marcel Desautels Doctoral Fellowship in Management, McGill University ($7,500).	2025
Rathlyn Foundation Fellowship, McGill University ($18,900).	2024
Edith and Norman Strauss Fellowship, McGill University ($6,100).	2024
Entrance Award, University of Toronto ($9,000).	2022
Mention of Excellence; Dean's List, Université de Montréal.	2018–2022
Jean-Marie-Dufour Prize in Econometrics, Université de Montréal ($1,000).	2021

CONFERENCES AND ACADEMIC EVENTS

41st Contemporary Accounting Research Conference and Doctoral Consortium Oct 22–24, 2026
Participant. Conference at UQÀM; doctoral consortium at McGill University.

12th Annual International Corporate Governance Society (ICGS) Conference and CGIR Junior Scholar Consortium Oct 2–4, 2026
Presenter, "Measuring Firm-Level Geopolitical Exposure." Participant, CGIR Junior Scholar Consortium and Paper Development Workshop. HEC Montréal.

6th Joint Ph.D. Program Symposium for Doctoral Students in Accounting Nov 21, 2025
Participant. John Molson School of Business, Concordia University.

McGill Accounting Research Conference (MARC) and Doctoral Consortium Jun 6–7, 2025
Participant. Desautels Faculty of Management, McGill University.

Montreal Accounting Ph.D. Forum Nov 15, 2024
Participant. Desautels Faculty of Management, McGill University.

TEACHING ASSISTANTSHIPS

McGill University, Desautels Faculty of Management Jan 2025–Dec 2025
Graduate Teaching Assistant: Financial Accounting.

University of Toronto Sep 2022–May 2023
Graduate Teaching Assistant: Data Analysis and Applied Econometrics; Principles of Macroeconomics; Quantitative Methods in Economics.

Université de Montréal Sep 2021–Feb 2022
Teaching Assistant: Mathematics for Economists.

AÉÉSÉUM (Economics Students' Association, Université de Montréal) Sep 2021–Jan 2022
Teaching Assistant: Mathematics for Economists.

SERVICE

Montreal Accounting PhD Club 2025–present
Founding President. Organizes events for accounting doctoral students across Montréal's four business schools.

PROFESSIONAL AND VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

Jarislowsky, Fraser Limited May 2022–Aug 2022
Institutional Intern. Montreal, QC.

Great Power Geopolitics Apr 2022–May 2023
Founder. Independent publication on great-power geopolitics.

Nature Simulation Systems 2017–2020
Patent Assistant. Montreal, QC.

CHU Sainte-Justine May 2015–Aug 2015
Volunteer. Montreal, QC.

TECHNICAL SKILLS AND TRAINING

Programming: Python, R, Stata, MATLAB, SQL, LaTeX.

Training: Machine Learning Specialization (Stanford Online and DeepLearning.AI); Machine Learning with Python (IBM); R Programming (Johns Hopkins University); Linear Regression and Modeling and Behavioral Finance (Duke University); Bloomberg Market Concepts and Bloomberg ESG (Bloomberg).

LANGUAGES

English and French (native or bilingual); Mandarin Chinese (professional working proficiency).